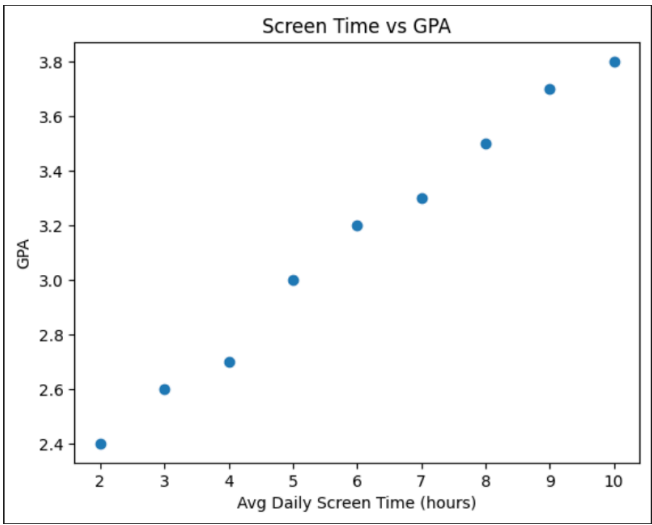
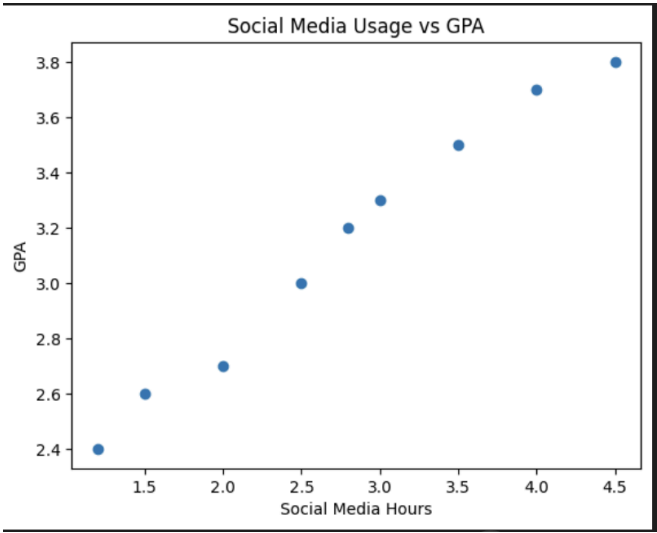
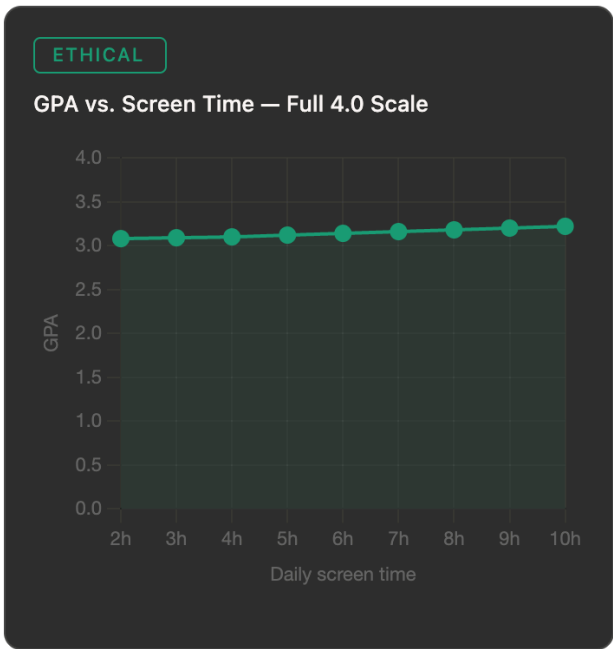
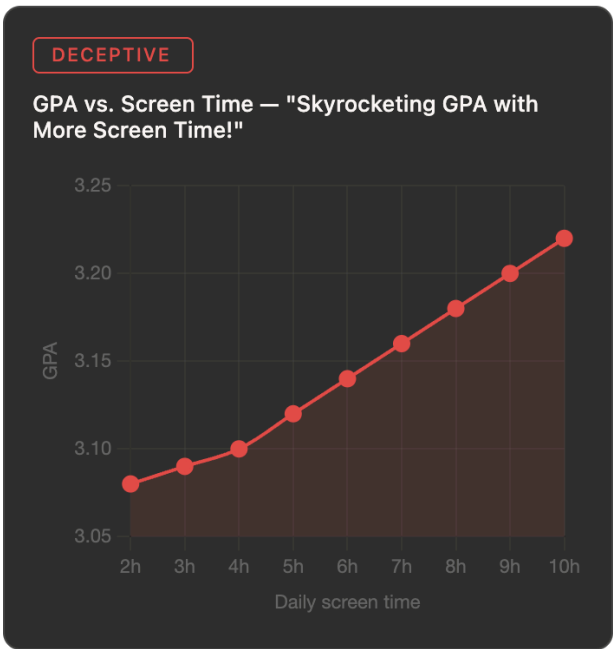


GRADE 75%

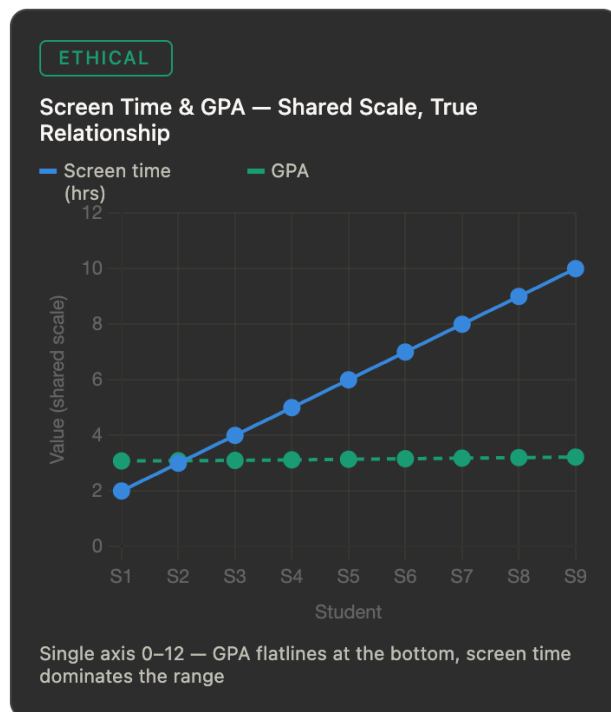
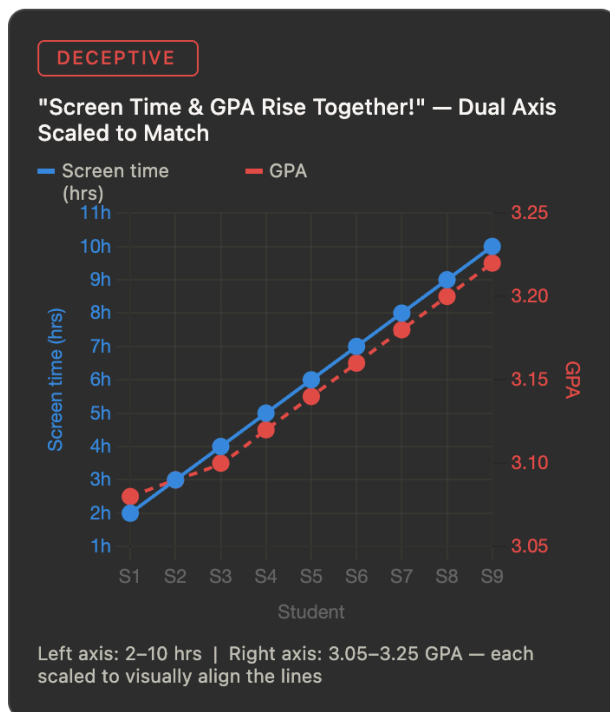
2 AI-generated charts (ChatGPT)



2 AI-generated charts (Cluade)



Y-axis starts at 3.05 on the left — a 0.14 GPA difference looks like a dramatic surge. The right chart shows the full 0–4.0 scale: it's nearly flat.



HIGH SCREEN TIME LINKED TO HIGHER GPA

You're on your phone late at night, just scrolling. One video turns into another, then another, and suddenly you realize hours have passed. You pause for a second and think - this can't be good for me, right? Shouldn't I be cutting my phone time down if I actually want to do well in school?

That assumption is being called into question by new data on student screen habits and academic performance.

A recent dataset examining college students' daily screen use and GPA patterns shows an unexpected trend: students reporting the highest levels of screen time - often 8 to 10 hours per day - also tend to have some of the highest GPAs. In addition, these students are frequently among the most active users of social media platforms.

At first glance, the finding appears counterintuitive. High screen exposure has typically been associated with distraction, reduced attention span, and poorer academic outcomes. However, the observed pattern suggests a more complex relationship may be at play.

One possible explanation is that heavy screen use increases familiarity with digital environments that are now central to higher education. From learning management systems to online research tools, much of modern academic life is mediated through screens. Students who are constantly engaged with digital platforms may therefore develop greater fluency in navigating academic tasks online.

Another factor may be the nature of the content itself. Social media often requires rapid reading, interpretation, and response. While often dismissed as passive consumption, this constant engagement may involve continuous cognitive processing that keeps users mentally active.

The findings challenge the simple idea that more screen time is automatically harmful. Instead, they point to a different reality: in today's digital learning environment, heavy screen use is not a disadvantage - but it is an advantage. Students who spend more time on their screens are not falling behind; they are keeping up, adapting, and in many cases, getting ahead.